Who Uses the Herbarium

The public, researchers, students from universities, colleges and various schools, Department of Wildlife and National Parks, environmental consultants, police forensic department.

Links With National and Regional Herbaria

The National Herbarium (GAB) has links with the University of Botswana Herbarium (UCBG), Sebele Herbarium (MAH) and Harry Oppenheimer Okavango Research Centre Herbarium, Maun (PSUB), as well as regional and international herbaria.

Within the country the herbarium has links with other government departments and non governmental organizations such as the National Tree Seed Centre. National Conservation Strategy Coordinating Agency, Thusano Lefatsheng, Kalahari Conservation Society and veld product Research -------, Forestry Association of Botswana e.t.c.

Location

The Botswana National Herbarium is located at The Village, plot 17991, Okwa road opposite Gaborone Club.

Information for the General Public

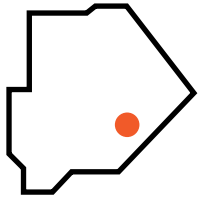
The Herbarium is closed on public holidays.

Opening Hours

Monday to Friday
8.30 am-4.00pm







Designation:
Natural & Cultural
Area: approx. 3km²
Adoption priorities:
visitor interpretation centre, field assistants signage, trails

For further information, contact:
The Archaeology Division, Botswana National Museum
Private Bag 00114 Gaborone, Botswana
Phone: +267 3974616 Fax: +267 3911186 / 3902797

HERBARIUM

BOTSWANA national museum

ADOPT A MONUMENT
GIVING LIFE TO BOTSWANA'S HERITAGE SITES

HE201511

Natural heritage site **Cultural heritage site**

HERBARIUM

What is a Herbarium

It is any collection of plant specimens carefully prepared and preserved for scientific research, posterity and future national reference purposes. The herbarium also serves as a teaching facility for the public. Our collections are mainly plants from Botswana and a few from neighbouring countries.







Brief History

The national Herbarium was established in 1975 as a division of the National Museum, Monuments and Art Gallery by the then Director Mr A.C. Campbell , assisted by Mr P.A. Smith who was for a long time with the Department of Water Affairs. The Herbarium's initial collection was obtained from the Ministry of Agriculture, comprising three thousand specimens which included those from O.B. Miller, L Hansen and volunteers such as Mrs Janet Barnes.

The herbarium collection houses approximately 10 000 specimens collected over the past 28 years. Dr L.M. Turton, Dr Wayne Handlos, Mrs A. Kreulen and Mrs Edna Norman were amongst those who helped to start the Herbarium.

At its inception, Mrs Ellen Kalake was appointed the Herbarium Assistant and learnt the basics of botany, plant identification as well as specimen mounting from Mrs Barnes and Dr Turton. She was later sent to the herbarium at the Royal Botanical Garden at Kew in London, where she gained experience in herbarium management.

Objectives

- To collect and preserve plant specimens of Botswana
- To gather information about plants and their uses
- To serve as a reference collection for plant taxonomy
- To locate rare and endangered plant species in order to develop strategies for conserving them.
- To promote awareness in plant conservation with the aim of preserving endangered and rare species.

To maintain a classification of the Botswana flora, thus keeping a catalogue of indigenous plant information for future use.

Activities and Services

- The Herbarium educates the public about the importance of plants and their and their preservation, particularly students engaged in environmental studies.
- Assists the local community with the identification of plants.
- Promotes research pertaining to local flora.
- Ethnobotanical research

The Herbarium loans plant species to other institutions and researchers.

Projects At The National Herbarium

- Organizing collecting expeditions
- Computerization of specimens into a regional data base called PRECIS.